FLAKY TART DOUGH

MAKES	ACTIVE TIME	REST	TOTAL TIME
2 tart or pie shells, 23 or 25 cm, or 12 tartlet shells at 10 cm	**25 min**	**2 h chilled minimum or overnight, then 30 min to 1 h once lined**	**3 h 30 min to 4 h**

OVEN
375F / 190C, about 20 min partially baked or 30 min fully baked

INGREDIENTS

1 tsp	Salt
150 ml	Water, very cold
455 g	All-purpose flour
300 g	Unsalted butter, very cold

METHOD

1. Stir the salt into the cold water until it dissolves. Keep the bowl refrigerated until you need it.
2. Cut the butter into 2.5 cm pieces.
3. Using a food processor, weigh the flour into the processor bowl and scatter the butter across the top. Pulse briefly, stopping at coarse crumbs with plenty of butter still at pea size. Pour in the salted water and pulse a few seconds more, until the dough is clumping toward a ball but is still rough and you can see chunks of butter in it.
4. Working by hand, weigh the flour into a mixing bowl and scatter the butter over the top, then cut it in with a pastry blender or two knives to the same coarse crumb, leaving pea-size butter. Drizzle the salted water over and stir with a fork to a shaggy mass, then bring it gently together into a ball. Stop while it is still rough with butter showing.
5. Split the dough in two on a lightly floured bench and pat each half into a disk 2.5 cm thick. Wrap tightly and chill at least 2 hours, or overnight.
6. To line a pan, roll a disk out to 3 mm on a lightly floured surface, working from the middle outward in every direction. Lift the sheet and swing it a quarter turn every few passes, dust underneath whenever it grabs, and move fast so the butter stays cold.
7. For a pie dish, cut a circle 5 cm wider than the dish. For a tart pan with a removable base, cut it 4 cm wider.
8. Fold the round in half or into quarters to carry it, lay it in the pan, settle it into the bottom and up the sides, and press it home gently. Trim it flush with the rim using a sharp knife.
9. In a pie dish you can instead leave a 12 mm overhang, fold it under itself and crimp or flute the edge. The bakery leaves the edge plain.
10. A shell that goes into the oven unbaked only needs refrigerating until you use it, covered with plastic wrap if that is overnight.
11. A shell you intend to blind bake has to be chilled firm to the touch first, 30 minutes to 1 hour. This is what buys you the flakiest crust.
12. Heat the oven to 375F. Line the chilled shell with parchment paper and fill it with pie weights.
13. For a partially baked shell, give it about 20 minutes, until the surface is dry and pale with no damp opaque patches left. Lift a corner of the paper to check. Lift out the weights and paper and return the shell for a few minutes more.
14. Watch the base while it bakes. If it domes up, pierce it with the tip of a knife, keeping the hole small if a very liquid filling is going in.
15. For a fully baked shell, run about 25 minutes under the weights, until the surface is light brown. Take out the weights and paper and bake 5 minutes more, to golden brown.
16. Cool the shells completely on wire racks before filling them.

NOTES

455 g flour to 300 g butter to 150 ml water is the 3:2:1 ratio by weight the dough is built on, so it scales up and down directly.
The pea-size butter is the whole point. Rolled out, the sheet should show faint streaks of butter.
Chilling before the bake sets pockets of flour and water around each piece of butter. Those pockets survive the oven and give the fork-tender texture.
For the einkorn version, replace the all-purpose flour with equal parts pastry flour and einkorn flour.
Tartine also mixes this dough by a longer method that comes out closer to rough puff. That version is the one used for galettes.

PRESERVING

The dough itself keeps far better than a lined shell, and a lined shell keeps better frozen than refrigerated.
Wrapped disks need 2 hours in the fridge at minimum and sit happily overnight.
A lined, unbaked shell can be well wrapped and frozen up to 2 weeks. Bake it straight from frozen, with no thawing.
Baked shells keep well wrapped for 1 week refrigerated or 2 weeks frozen.
Fill a baked shell only once it is cold, or the steam softens the crust.